



ANURADHA THAKUR

SECRETARY, DEPARTMENT OF
ECONOMIC AFFAIRS

Policy watchers know that the Union Finance Ministry has had few women secretaries and Anuradha Thakur's appointment as Secretary, Department of Economic Affairs made her the first woman in the role. Thakur, a 1994-batch IAS officer of the Himachal cadre, has a key role in guiding economic policy and working on measures to sustain growth amidst the external turbulence from the US tariffs and geopolitical risks. She is also a crucial member of the Budget making team for 2026-27 and is in charge of Budget estimates and policy proposals.



VANDANA GURNANI

SECRETARY, MINISTRY OF
LABOUR & EMPLOYMENT

Labour reforms have been at the centre of the government's policy initiatives and Gurnani has been spearheading many. A 1991-batch IAS officer of the Karnataka cadre, Gurnani has been instrumental in the rollout of the Labour Codes and remains busy in its implementation. Welfare of workers, ease of living, simplifying compliances and boosting employment are her focus areas. She is working on measures like employment-linked incentives, draft national employment policy and reforms in EPFO and ESIC.



POONAM GUPTA

DEPUTY GOVERNOR,
RESERVE BANK OF
INDIA

**Reserve Bank of India
Deputy Governor
Poonam Gupta has one of the most critical roles in today's turbulent times in shaping the economy. She is, after all, the Deputy Governor in charge of the crucial departments including economic policy and research and monetary policy. She is also a member of the Monetary Policy Committee that decides on policy rates and keeps inflation in check. She is also the first woman to hold the DG position in the RBI in over a decade. A globally renowned economist, she was previously heading the think tank National Council of Applied Economic Research and was a member of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister.**

